

ICELANDIC WAGES ARE NOT IMMUNE TO COLD SHRINKAGE

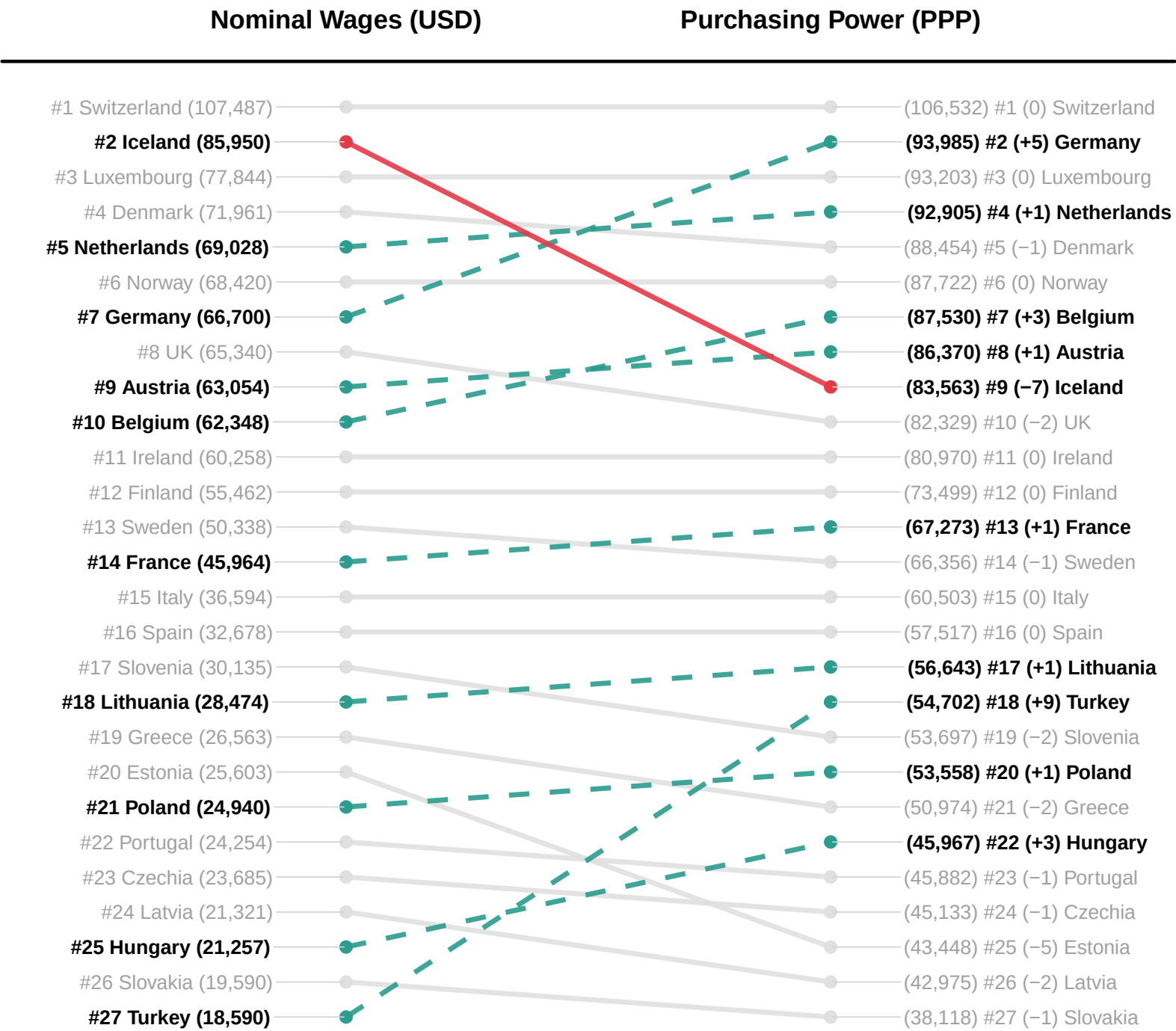
The 2nd highest salaries in Europe *shrink sharply to 9th place* once exposed to the brutal cost of living in Iceland.

Data Visualisation by victor.blaer@fyi-lab.is | May 20, 2026

According to the OECD Taxing Wages 2026 report¹, when local prices are factored in, real purchasing power shifts dramatically across Europe. Despite boasting the second-highest nominal wages, **ICELAND** suffers a glacial cold plunge that not only shrinks certain male body parts but also their purchasing power – dropping 7 places to 9th overall when adjusted for cost of living. Meanwhile, – – – **green cohorts** maintain or expand their footprint.

Purchasing power parity (PPP) are the rates of currency conversion that equalise the purchasing power of different currencies by eliminating the differences in price levels between countries. The figures here are based on US dollars, as euro-based PPP data is not released yet.

Editorial note: Media and reporting agencies often do a poor job of communicating the data story, leaving readers confused by convoluted filter logic. The news is frequently flooded with misleading headlines like "mOsT biGgEsT salArY groWth in EUrope among left-handed, green-eyed workers whose favorite football team is Liverpool and live with their moms," completely misleading the public by ignoring the bigger picture. This chart strictly visualizes the standard base case: a single individual without children earning the average wage.



¹ Source: OECD Taxing Wages 2026 (https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/taxing-wages-2026_3a5169ef-en.html)
Source: Euronews (<https://www.euronews.com/business/2026/05/15/average-wages-across-europe-countries-with-the-highest-and-lowest-salaries>)
*USD PPP. Wages for a single worker without children earning the average wage. The public sector and agriculture are not included.